CHAPTER TWO

The West's Auto-Immune Disease

Melanie Phillips

Israel's status as the world's pariah state has become a given for progressives in Britain and Europe. It is a viewpoint which turns evidence, truth, logic, and morality upside-down in a unique campaign of vilification based on lies, distortions, and viciously selective reporting. Such a total eclipse of reason incites hatred and violence not just against Israel but against Jews, the prejudice against whom lies at its core.

In the summer of 2014, this poisonous animus exploded into attacks on Jews in Britain and Europe as a response to the reporting of the conflict in Gaza. In France, there was a near-pogrom at a synagogue and Jews were attacked in the street. In the Netherlands, the Chief Rabbi's house was repeatedly attacked. In Britain, there was a fivefold rise in attacks on Jews, both verbal and physical.

This hatred and violence was incited by the astonishingly twisted media reporting of Operation Protective Edge, Israel's military action in Gaza taken in response to thousands of rocket attacks and murderous tunnelling incursions into Israel by Hamas and other Islamic terror outfits. Despite the unprecedented lengths to which the Israel defence forces went to prevent the loss of civilian life, even though Hamas was ruthlessly using much of Gaza's population as human shields and sacrifices, the Israelis were depicted as heartless, brutal child-killers.

Given that the British and European public were bombarded by sickening images of dead children, in what was effectively a Hamas propaganda campaign reproduced uncritically by western media outlets, it was hardly surprising that public opinion turned so badly against Israel and that Muslims in particular were inflamed. What was notable, however, was the display of open antisemitism as people instinctively held Jews collectively responsible for what were perceived as Israel's crimes.

Thus much is both explicable, albeit as a dismal commentary on western collusion with terrorism, and at the same time ultimately inexplicable insofar

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,